

DocChat Employee Handbook

Version 2.1 | Effective January 2025

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1. Welcome to DocChat

Our Mission

DocChat revolutionizes how organizations interact with their knowledge base through intelligent AI-powered document understanding and conversational interfaces.

Company History

Founded in 2023 by Sarah Chen and Michael Rodriguez, DocChat emerged from their frustration with traditional document management systems. Starting with a seed round of \$2.3M, we've grown to 47 employees across San Francisco, Austin, and remote locations.

Our Vision

To make organizational knowledge instantly accessible and actionable through natural language interactions.

2. Company Culture & Values

Core Values

Innovation First

- We embrace cutting-edge AI technologies
- Continuous learning is expected and supported
- Failure is viewed as a learning opportunity

Customer Obsession

- Every decision considers customer impact
- We measure success by customer outcomes
- Direct customer feedback drives product decisions

Transparency

- Open communication across all levels
- Regular all-hands meetings (Fridays 3 PM PT)
- Salary bands and equity information available to all employees

Work-Life Balance

- Flexible working hours (core hours: 10 AM - 3 PM PT)
- Unlimited PTO policy with 3-week minimum
- No-meeting Wednesdays

3. Employment Policies

Working Hours

- Standard full-time: 40 hours per week
- Core collaboration hours: 10 AM - 3 PM Pacific Time
- Flexible schedule with manager approval

Remote Work Policy

- Hybrid model: minimum 2 days in office (SF/Austin)
- Full remote available for senior employees (L4+)
- Monthly team meetups for remote employees

Time Off

- **Vacation:** Unlimited with 3-week minimum annual usage
- **Sick Leave:** Unlimited, no questions asked
- **Parental Leave:** 16 weeks paid for primary caregiver, 8 weeks for secondary

- **Mental Health Days:** Encouraged, count as sick leave

Holidays Observed

- New Year's Day
 - Martin Luther King Jr. Day
 - Presidents' Day
 - Memorial Day
 - Independence Day
 - Labor Day
 - Indigenous Peoples' Day
 - Thanksgiving (Thu-Fri)
 - Winter Break: December 24 - January 2
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4. Benefits & Compensation

Health Benefits

- **Medical:** 100% premium covered for employee, 80% for dependents
- **Dental & Vision:** 100% premium covered
- **Mental Health:** \$200/month wellness stipend
- **Health Savings Account:** Company contributes \$1,200 annually

Financial Benefits

- **401(k):** 6% company match, immediate vesting
- **Equity:** All employees receive stock options
- **Life Insurance:** 2x annual salary
- **Disability Insurance:** Short and long-term coverage

Professional Development

- **Learning Budget:** \$3,000 annually per employee
- **Conference Attendance:** One major conference per year
- **Internal Training:** Bi-weekly tech talks and workshops
- **Book Allowance:** \$500 annually

Perks

- **Lunch Stipend:** \$25/day when in office
- **Home Office Setup:** \$2,000 budget for equipment
- **Commuter Benefits:** \$200/month transit allowance
- **Team Events:** Quarterly off-sites and monthly social events

5. Technology & Security

Equipment Policy

- **Laptop:** MacBook Pro 16" or equivalent Windows/Linux machine
- **Monitor:** 27" 4K display for office and home
- **Accessories:** Ergonomic keyboard, mouse, webcam, headset
- **Mobile:** iPhone or Android with monthly plan allowance

Security Requirements

- **Password Policy:** Use company-provided password manager (1Password)
- **Two-Factor Authentication:** Required for all systems
- **VPN:** Mandatory for accessing internal systems
- **Device Encryption:** Full disk encryption required
- **Software Updates:** Auto-update enabled, critical patches within 48 hours

Acceptable Use

- Company equipment for business and reasonable personal use
- No illegal activities or content
- Respect intellectual property rights
- Report security incidents immediately to IT

Data Classification

- **Public:** Marketing materials, published documentation
- **Internal:** Employee information, internal processes
- **Confidential:** Customer data, financial information
- **Restricted:** Source code, trade secrets, security credentials

6. Performance & Development

Performance Reviews

- **Frequency:** Quarterly check-ins, annual formal reviews
- **360 Feedback:** Includes peers, direct reports, and manager input
- **Goal Setting:** OKRs (Objectives and Key Results) quarterly alignment
- **Career Laddering:** Clear progression paths for all roles

Professional Development Programs

- **Mentorship:** Formal mentoring program pairing junior and senior employees
- **Cross-functional Projects:** Encouraged to work outside primary role
- **Speaking Opportunities:** Support for conference presentations and podcasts
- **Open Source Contributions:** 10% time allocation allowed

Promotion Process

- Self-nomination or manager recommendation
 - Peer review and technical assessment
 - Presentation to promotion committee
 - Decision timeline: 4-6 weeks
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7. Code of Conduct

Professional Behavior

- Treat all colleagues, customers, and partners with respect
- Embrace diversity and inclusion in all interactions
- Communicate clearly and constructively
- Honor commitments and deadlines

Ethical Guidelines

- Maintain confidentiality of proprietary information
- Avoid conflicts of interest
- Report suspected violations to HR or management
- Comply with all applicable laws and regulations

Anti-Harassment Policy

DocChat maintains a zero-tolerance policy for harassment, discrimination, or retaliation. This includes:

- Verbal or physical harassment
- Discriminatory comments or actions
- Unwelcome sexual advances
- Retaliation against those who report violations

Reporting Procedures

- **Direct Manager:** First point of contact for most issues
- **HR Director:** Sarah Kim (sarah.kim@docchat.com)
- **Anonymous Hotline:** 1-800-DocChat (24/7)

- **Ethics Email:** ethics@docchat.com
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8. Emergency Procedures

Office Emergencies

- **Fire:** Follow posted evacuation routes, meet at designated areas
- **Earthquake:** Drop, cover, hold. Evacuate if safe to do so
- **Medical Emergency:** Call 911, notify office manager
- **Security Threat:** Follow lockdown procedures, contact security

Business Continuity

- **Remote Work Capability:** All employees equipped for full remote work
- **Communication Channels:** Slack for internal, customer portal for external
- **Data Backup:** Automatic cloud backup of all critical systems
- **Recovery Time Objective:** 4 hours for critical systems

Contact Information

- **Emergency Services:** 911
 - **Office Security:** (415) 555-0199
 - **IT Helpdesk:** it-support@docchat.com
 - **HR After Hours:** (415) 555-0167
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Appendices

A. Organizational Chart

Available on internal wiki: wiki.docchat.com/org-chart

B. Office Maps & Procedures

- San Francisco Office: 350 Bush Street, Floor 15
- Austin Office: 500 West 2nd Street, Floor 8

C. IT Support Contacts

- **Helpdesk:** it-support@docchat.com
- **Security Issues:** security@docchat.com

- **Equipment Requests:** equipment@docchat.com